

SILVERMAN-ANDERSEN RETRACTION SCORE

Assessment of Respiratory Distress in Newborns and Preterm Infants

1. PATIENT IDENTIFICATION

Patient Name: _____

Age / DOB: ____/____/____

MRN / ID: _____

Unit / Ward / Bed: _____

Surgery / Diagnosis: _____

Date / Time: ____/____/____ : ____

FIVE OBSERVATIONAL RESPIRATORY CRITERIA

Clinical Parameter	Options & Scoring Criteria	Score
1. Upper Chest Thoracoabdominal respiratory synchrony	☐ Synchronized: Chest and abdomen rise together (0) ☐ Lag on inspiration: Chest lag, abdomen rises (1) ☐ Seesaw: Complete seesaw paradox movement (2)	[]
2. Lower Chest Intercostal retractions	☐ None: No intercostal retractions visible (0) ☐ Mild: Just visible lower intercostal retractions (1) ☐ Marked: Deep prominent intercostal indrawing (2)	[]
3. Xiphoid Retraction Substernal indrawing	☐ None: No substernal indrawing (0) ☐ Mild: Barely visible subxiphoid retraction (1) ☐ Marked: Marked deep xiphoid retraction (2)	[]
4. Nares Dilation Nasal flaring	☐ None: Normal quiet nasal breathing (0) ☐ Mild: Minimal transient nasal flaring (1) ☐ Marked: Marked continuous flaring of nostrils (2)	[]
5. Expiratory Grunt Audible respiratory noise	☐ None: No grunt audible (0) ☐ Audible with stethoscope only (1) ☐ Audible with naked ear without stethoscope (2)	[]

TOTAL SCORE: [] POINTS (Maximum: 10 points (0 to 10)) **Assessor (RN / License #):** _____**CLINICAL INTERPRETATION & RECOMMENDED NURSING ACTIONS****No Respiratory Distress (0 points)**

Normal neonatal breathing pattern. Routine thermal and respiratory surveillance.

Mild Respiratory Distress (1 - 3 points)

Supplemental humidified oxygen, CPAP consideration, aspirate secretions.

Moderate Distress (4 - 6 points)

Nasal CPAP / High Flow nasal cannula, blood gas analysis, chest X-ray.

Severe Respiratory Failure (7 - 10 points)

Imminent respiratory failure. Urgent endotracheal intubation, mechanical ventilation, NICU.

Registered Nurse (RN) Signature & Professional Stamp

Date & Time of Assessment